

POOR POPE, POOR BASTARD

*How the man who took a vow of poverty controls
€6 billion and literally owns the Vatican Bank.*

COMPILED FROM INVESTIGATIVE RECORDS & PUBLIC SOURCES

The vow of poverty applies to the man, but the money flows to the office.

The Man (Personal Capacity)



Absolute vow of poverty



Modest personal wardrobe



Shared meals



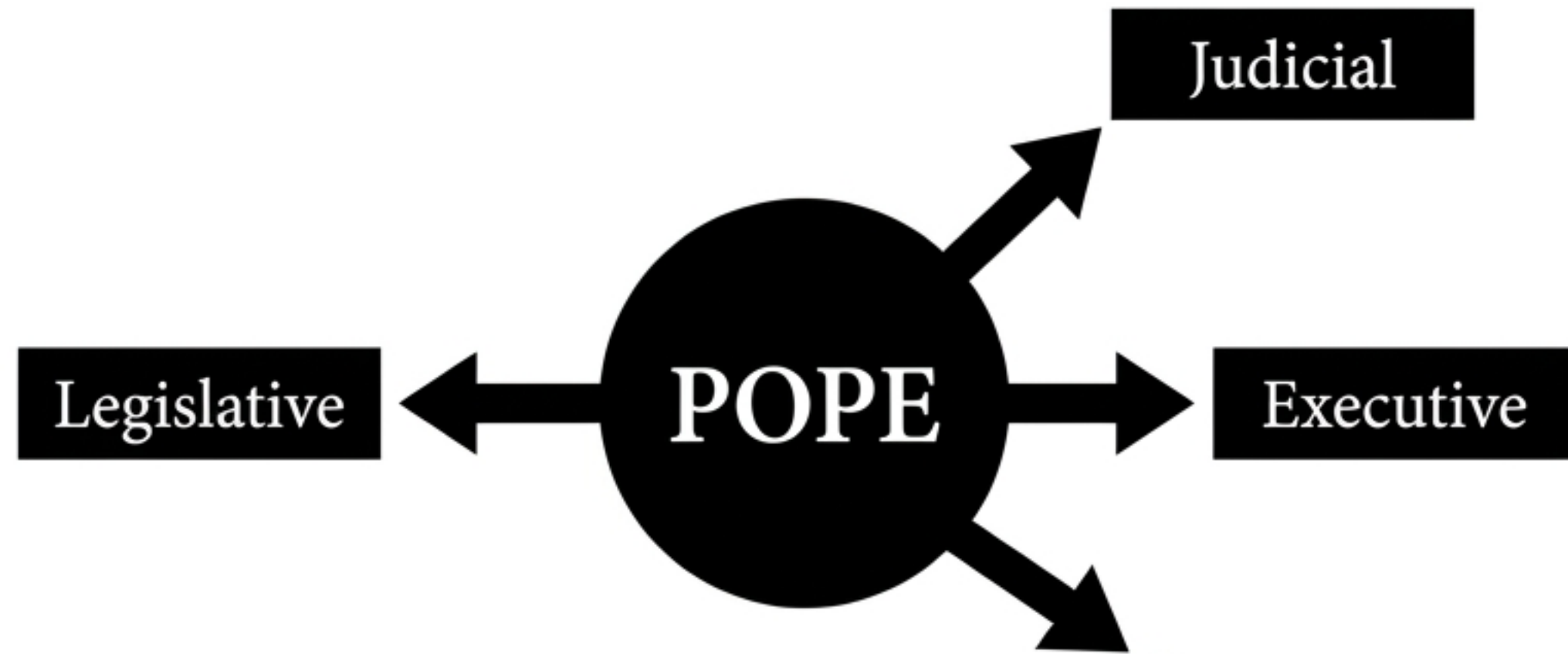
Zero private bank accounts

The Sovereign (Holy See Capacity)

- Controls **€6 Billion** in IOR-managed assets
- Controls **€700 Million** in real estate
- Incalculable art collections (Michelangelo, Bernini)
- Collects **€24.3 Million** annual dividend
- Absolute diplomatic & legal immunity

This is not a paradox. It is a design feature.

Vatican City operates as an absolute elective monarchy.

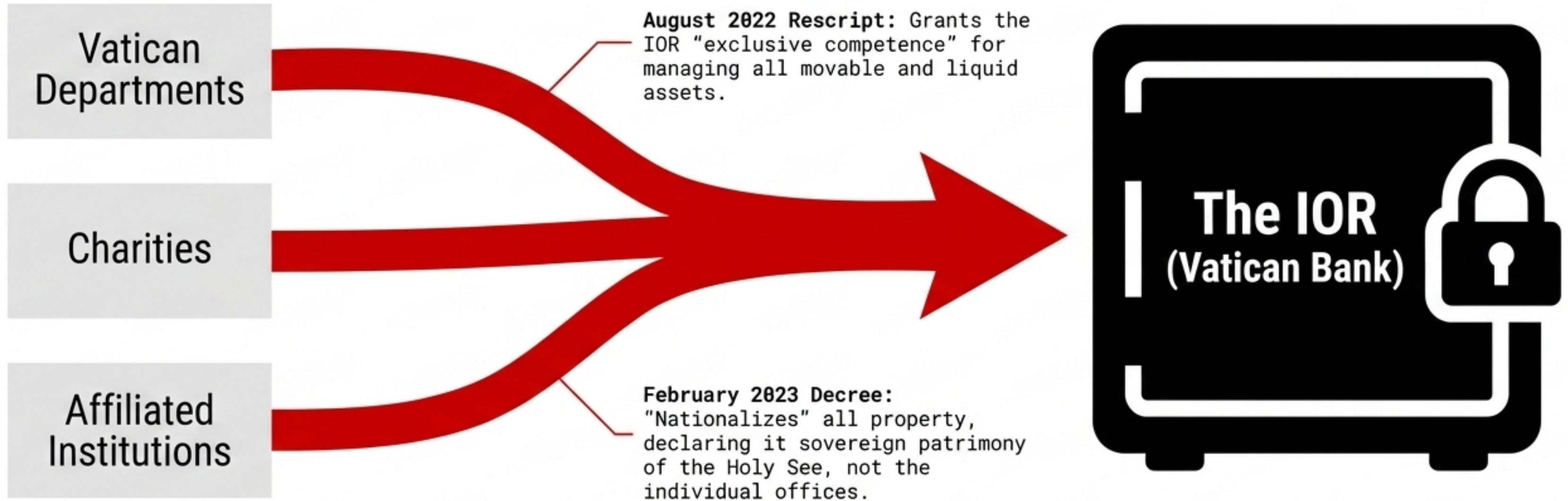


The Lateran Treaty of 1929 established the Pope's exclusive and absolute power and jurisdiction. In 2023, Francis's new Fundamental Law reaffirmed that the supreme pontiff possesses all governmental powers.

The Pope's Powers

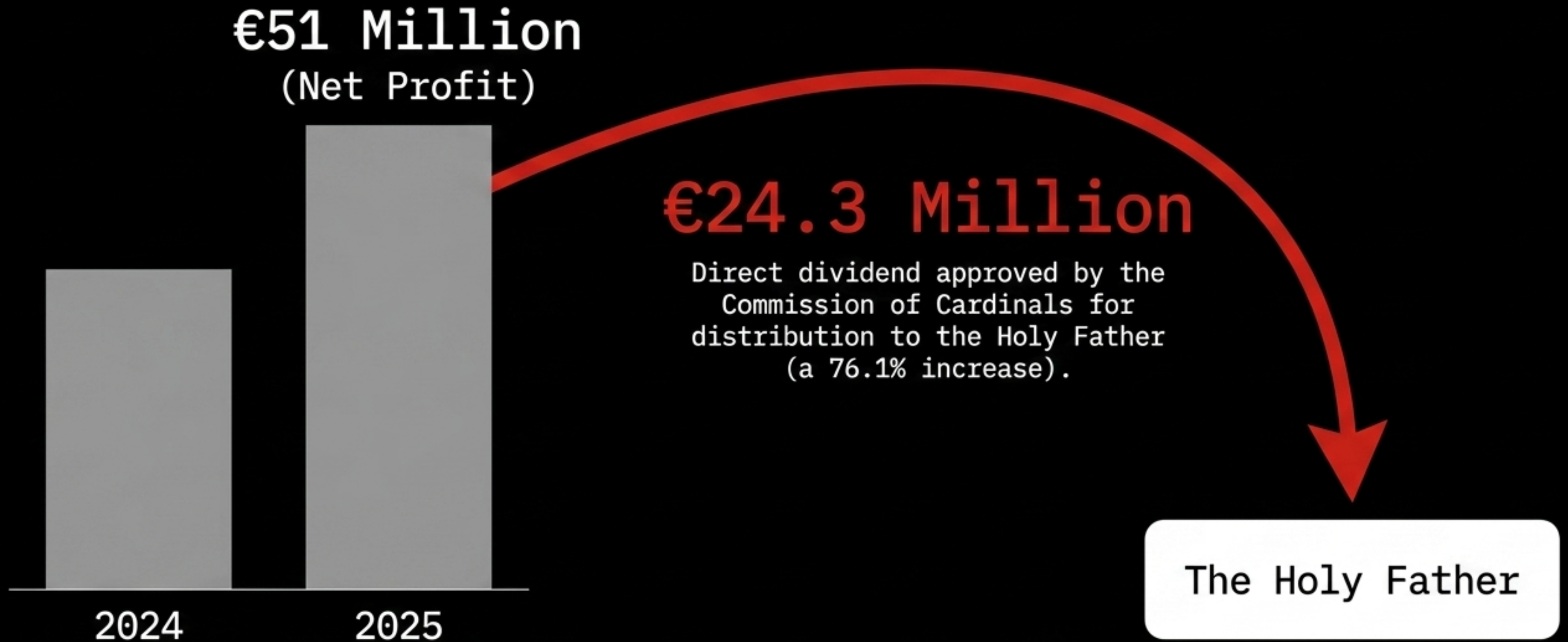
- Appoints all IOR management
- Sets all asset management policies
- Receives all profits & controls spending
- Immune from Italian/EU regulatory oversight
- Can amend Vatican law unilaterally

Recent decrees have funneled all Vatican assets into a single bank.



The Holy See is the Pope. The Pope is the Holy See. The assets are his.

The Pope's bank generates a massive personal dividend.



Note: The IOR operates as a canonical foundation with no private owners. The dividend is a distribution from an institution the Pope owns to an account he controls as sovereign.

Historical scandals reveal a systemic feature, not an anomaly.

HALL OF SCANDALS		
1982 — Banco Ambrosiano	2002-2007 — The Caloia Scheme	2014-2018 — The Becciu Property
The Scheme: \$1.5B fraud via fake letters of patronage.	The Scheme: IOR President Angelo Caloia manipulated real estate sales to steal €19M. Total scheme valued at €59M.	The Scheme: €200M investment in Chelsea, London luxury real estate rife with improper broker fees.
The Fallout: IOR lost \$250M. Bank president Roberto Calvi ('God's Banker') found hanged under a London bridge.		The Fallout: Holy See lost approximately €139M.
The Consequence: Vatican paid \$244M settlement; admitted no wrongdoing.	The Consequence: First jail sentence ever issued by a Vatican court for financial crimes (8 years, 11 months).	The Consequence: No. 3 Vatican official convicted. (See next slide).

A decades-long pattern of financial misconduct, proving the issue is systemic, not anomalous.

The sovereign can rewrite the rules during an active investigation

Dec 16, 2023

Cardinal Becciu convicted of embezzlement and sentenced to 5.5 years. The first time a cardinal was ever convicted by a Holy See court.



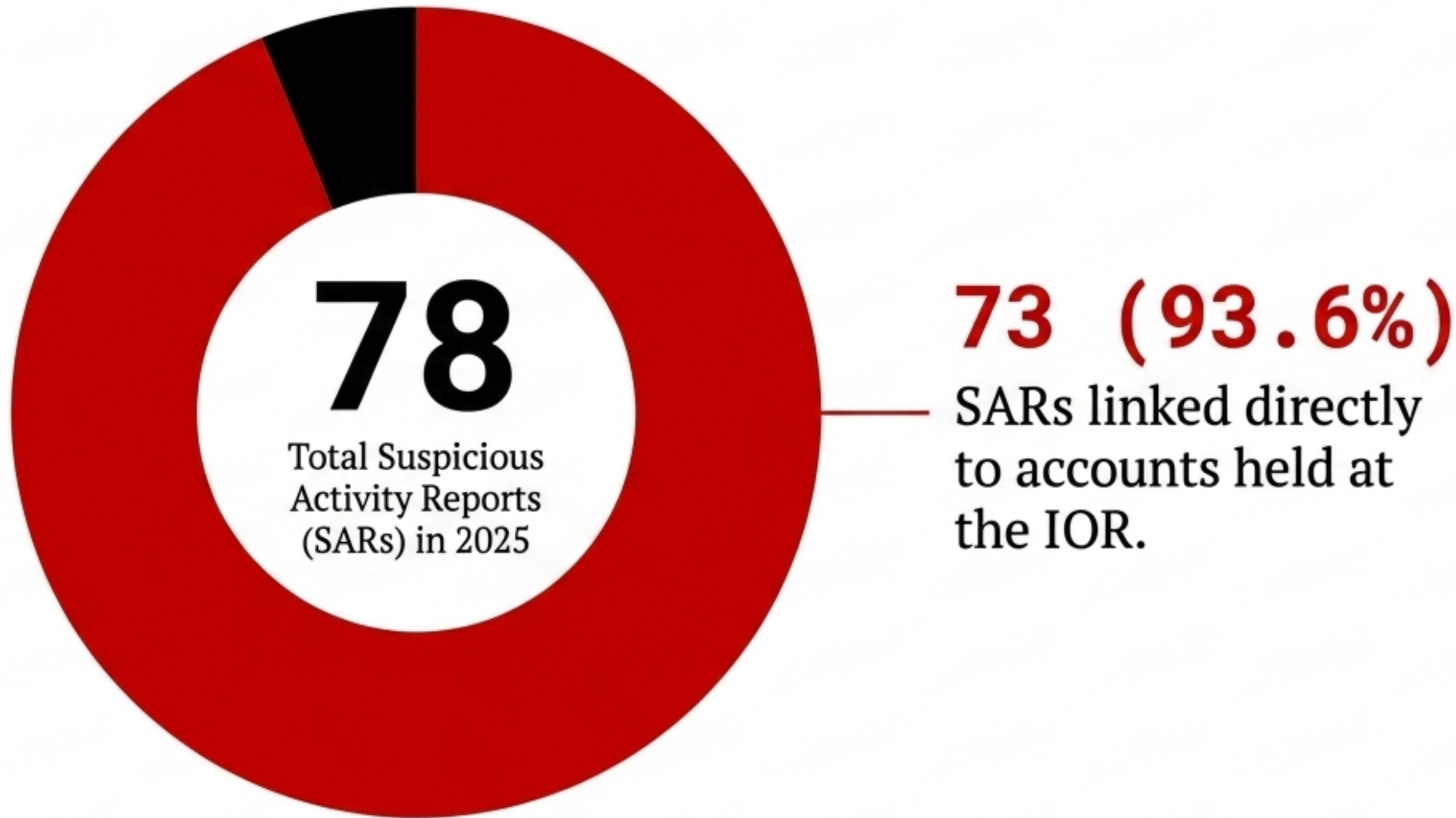
Mar 17, 2026

Court of Appeal declares a partial mistrial.

Why a mistrial? Pope Francis secretly issued four decrees during the investigation expanding prosecutors' powers, but hid them from the defense.

"The Pope was simultaneously the sovereign who issued the decrees, the head of the state whose courts were hearing the case, and the ultimate beneficiary of the funds at issue."

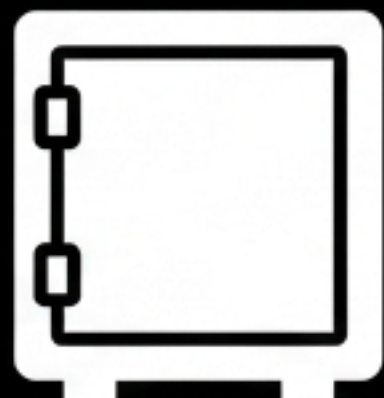
The Vatican's internal watchdogs are flagging the Pope's own bank.



Analytical Insight

This 93.6% concentration in a single institution is statistically massive. It indicates structural design flaws, insufficient controls, or continued illicit activity. The Vatican's intelligence unit is effectively raising the alarm on the bank that pays the Pope €24.3 million annually.

Opacity is legally engineered into the financial architecture.



The Beneficial Ownership Black Hole

- Despite meeting 35 of 39 Moneyval anti-money laundering recommendations, the Holy See refuses to require beneficial ownership disclosure.
- Because the IOR is a canonical foundation with no shares and sovereign immunity, the ultimate beneficiaries of its €6 billion portfolio remain completely legally opaque.



The 'Skeleton Key' Allegation

- Libero Milone, the Vatican's first Auditor General, alleged the existence of a secret tool that allows the Vatican payroll agency (APSA) to retrospectively alter international bank account numbers (IBANs) in the SWIFT system.
- He described it as a "skeleton key for money laundering." The allegation remains fiercely disputed but highlights profound institutional distrust.

Accountability is impossible when the sovereign is the system.

The Ultimate Conflict of Interest

The Pope is simultaneously the owner of the assets, the regulator of the bank, and the final judge in misconduct cases.

The Power of Clemency

The Pope holds unilateral power to alter legal procedures during investigations, issue pardons, and block Italian prosecutors at the border.

Absolute Opacity

€6 billion operates with sovereign immunity and zero requirement to disclose beneficial ownership or externally audit the €24.3M dividend spending.

The Illusion of Reform

All structural reforms rely entirely on voluntary papal discretion. A system based on the goodwill of an absolute monarch is not structural accountability.

“The system is not broken. It is working exactly as designed.”

Decades of documented systemic financial misconduct are the inevitable byproduct of a legal framework designed to protect absolute sovereign immunity above all else.

Absolute sovereignty precludes absolute accountability.

What Accountability Depends On

- ❑ Completion of the Becciu retrial (June 2026 onward)
- ❑ Technical investigation of Milone's IBAN allegations
- ❑ International coordination with Moneyval regulators
- ❑ Structural reforms mandating beneficial ownership disclosure

He is the absolute sovereign of Vatican City State.

He holds full legislative, executive, and judicial power.

He owns the bank.

He controls the bank.

He receives the bank's profits.

He took a vow of poverty.

Poor Pope. Poor bastard.